

For example, say you are in an online community, where someone posts a link to a YouTube video, like this <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dQw4w9WgXcQ>. But, in reality, they spike it, by putting in some domain name in place of YouTube, by like replacing an o with a O, which makes the link visually similar to a legit one. But when clicked, takes you to an illegitimate webpage. In some cases, the webpage you land on, might be even structured similar to the original webpage, which would put you at an even higher risk, because you are in the belief that you are on the right website, while you are not.

This is something that is going on all over the internet, and not only community forums on social media, but Google searches are riddled with such schemes, where scammers pay for ads, which appear on the Google pages of certain keywords, and if clicked, take users to a scam webpage.

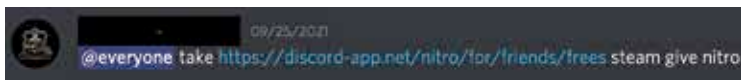
To avoid it, what you can do is take the following steps:

1. First, go to the actual website, where you think the link would redirect to, say YouTube.
2. Go to the link that had been sent to you and copy the part after the domain name.

(For example, in the case of the above YouTube link, take the highlighted part, as shown here: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dQw4w9WgXcQ>)

3. Paste this in the address bar of your browser, after the website name, which you are on, and then click enter.

What this will ensure is that you are on a legit, secured website, and not some scam webpage, which has been designed to lead you to some



Nothing seems wrong right? It is a fake link!

fishy neighbourhood of the internet. If the link that was sent to you was legit, you will get to the page that you were intended to in the first place, but if it was fake, you will get an error message.

Use Two-Factor Authentication

It has been said a million times before, and we know that most of you practice it and have it in use already, but this is just another reminder from us, enable two-factor authentication. Anyone who remotely knows